

Comments on D1-D9 and A1-A3

D1: i think that maybe we don't need remove `_lo` and `_hi` right away because we might need it for visualisation and interpretation?

D6: for next year forecasting it's probably better to train model on earlier years and evaluate on later years ; also here we should be cautious around 2020-2023 period

D7: Because missingness varies across regions, we should be cautious about using a single global mean or median for imputation. If imputation is needed, it should be fitted using training data only. As an initial approach, we could compare a core model without HIV-related variables with an extended model including them, rather than automatically imputing all missing HIV values.

A1 similarly to D7 : We could begin with a core dataset that excludes HIV-related variables to maximise country coverage. HIV-related indicators could be included in a separate extended analysis to assess whether they add predictive or descriptive value.

A3 i think it is said in the document what our goals for supervised and unsupervised analysis should be